

Learn Copywriting: Beginner's Guide

Lesson 4: Writing Benefits, Not Features

Writing Benefits, Not Features - Study Notes

Key Concepts

1. **Feature vs. Benefit** – A feature describes *what* a product has; a benefit explains *why* it matters to the user.
2. **Customer Centric Language** – Benefits are framed from the buyer's perspective, focusing on outcomes, emotions, or solved problems.
3. **Transformation Process** – Convert a technical attribute into a relatable advantage by asking “so what?” or “what does this enable?”
4. **Benefit Driven Copy** – Effective marketing copy leads with the benefit, then backs it up with the supporting feature.
5. **Quantifiable vs. Qualitative Benefits** – Some benefits can be measured (e.g., “30% faster load time”), while others are experiential (e.g., “peace of mind”).

Summary

When writing copy, the goal is to show the customer *what they gain*, not just *what the product contains*. A feature such as “8 /GB RAM” tells the reader a specification, but it does not answer the crucial question: *What does that do for me?* By translating the feature into a benefit—“smooth multitasking, so you can switch between apps without lag”—the copy connects the product to the user's needs and desires.

The transformation from feature to benefit follows a simple mental exercise: identify the feature, ask “so what?” or “what problem does this solve?”, and then phrase the answer as a clear, customer focused benefit. This approach makes copy more persuasive, improves comprehension, and increases the likelihood of conversion. Remember to keep the benefit front and center, using the feature as supporting evidence rather than the headline.

Important Points

- **Always ask “So what?”** after stating a feature; the answer is the benefit.
- **Speak the customer's language** – use everyday terms and focus on outcomes they care about.
- **Lead with benefits** in headlines and opening sentences; place features later as proof points.
- **Quantify when possible** (e.g., “up to 2 /x faster rendering”) to add credibility.
- **Avoid jargon** that only engineers understand; benefits should be instantly understandable.
- **Benefits can be functional, emotional, or social** (e.g., “feel confident presenting to clients”).
- **Test your copy** – ask a friend who isn't technical to read it; if they can't see the advantage, rework the benefit.

Examples

| Feature | Benefit (Bad) | Benefit (Good) | Explanation |

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| 8 /GB RAM | “Has 8 /GB RAM.” | “Enjoy smooth multitasking—switch between apps instantly without lag.” | The good benefit tells the user *why* the RAM matters: it enables a friction free experience. |

| 4K UHD display | “4K resolution screen.” | “See every detail vividly, so your photos and movies look lifelike.” | Moves from a technical spec to the visual impact on the user. |

| 2 year warranty | “Comes with a 2 year warranty.” | “Buy with confidence—any defects are covered for two years, no extra cost.” | Highlights peace of mind and risk reduction. |

Quick Review

1. What is the primary difference between a feature and a benefit?
2. How can you quickly turn a feature into a benefit? (Name the key question you ask.)
3. Give a benefit first rewrite for the feature “Bluetooth 5.0 connectivity.”
4. Why should benefits be placed before features in marketing copy?
5. List two types of benefits other than functional (e.g., emotional, social).

Further Reading

- ****Customer Focused Copywriting**** – techniques for speaking directly to buyer motivations.
- ****AIDA Model (Attention, Interest, Desire, Action)**** – structuring copy to guide the buyer journey.
- ****Storytelling in Marketing**** – weaving benefits into narratives for stronger emotional impact.
- ****Testing and Optimizing Copy**** – A/B testing benefits vs. features for conversion rates.

Use these notes to practice converting product specs into compelling benefits. The more you internalize the “so what?” mindset, the more persuasive your writing will become.

